What is Tavus Griffin

The Human Interaction Model that passed the Turing Test

—By **Vyom Ramani**

All AIs that you have seen on video calls share one common trait. The moment you finish your sentence, there is the pause. The pause during which the machine records what you said, processes it and produces speech and animation. According to Tavus, the new Griffin model puts an end to the pause.

What is Tavus Griffin

Griffin is a HIM (Human Interaction Model) in Tavus' words. It is an alluring term for a very straightforward concept. Typically, most live avatars operate through the relay process. One technology converts spoken words into text, another generates a response, and another gives voice to the response. Another one makes animated facial expressions. Each process involves delays and loss of information – your intonation or camera footage.

The Griffin system is one example of a video-to-video system which listens and observes as it speaks. Subsecond by subsecond, it determines if it needs to speak, nod, use "mm-hm" or be silent. This is how Griffin interrupts you and gets interrupted. Think about it – most technologies still wait for their turn like the teller at the bank.

The 48% claim

What really stood out was the 48% figure. In a study by Tavus using an independent research platform, 54 out of the total number of people tested believed they had communicated with



a human after watching a one-minute video call. The previous stack of Tavus scored 1 out of 41, translating to 2.4%.

Looks like passing the Turing test, but a narrow win indeed. Sixty seconds. Fifty-four people. Study conducted and performed by the company selling the technology, and no external replication of the findings. Original Turing test involved text only, while video Turing test is something that has been defined by Tavus. Some became wary within 20 seconds. Double the length of the conversation to an hour, and who knows.

How it works

One conversational model consumes audio and video data and produces control signals for speech, emotions, expressions and gestures. Another generation engine translates those control signals into voice and face. The former one can clone voices based on approximately 10 seconds of audio data. The latter one creates 720p video data in 320 millisecond increments based on just one picture reference, even the shadows of the chair.

Speed is the whole point. According to Tavus, Griffin achieves 0.43 second delay between audio input and face reaction time, that is twice as fast as the next fastest known technique. On NVIDIA's VideoFDB dataset, evaluated by NVIDIA, Griffin got 3.83 out of 5 scores on generation task comparing to human score 3.92. On perception task, Griffin got 3.73 out of 5 comparing to human 4.20. **tinyurl.com/d4t3gfd43**

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Scientists call for international AI safety body



Around 400 scientists from 34 countries have called for an international body to oversee advanced AI safety. Their proposal includes mandatory incident reporting, common safety standards, independent testing and isolating powerful AI models from external networks. The call comes amid concerns over AI cyberattacks and follows voluntary safety commitments by major tech companies. **tinyurl.com/d4tre34fde**

Google rolls out Gemini 4 Argon AI model after restricted release



Google has begun the global rollout of Gemini 4 Argon, its latest AI model for coding, scientific research, cybersecurity and complex reasoning. Google claims it can accelerate large-scale code refactoring, make quantum chemistry calculations up to 2.3 times faster and score 87% on the Embodied Reasoning benchmark. The model is available through Google's developer tools and Gemini, with paid access starting at $2 per million input and $10 per million output tokens. **tinyurl.com/g54hgtf**